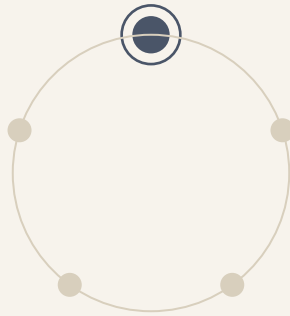


ONE OF THE 5 HIDDEN TRIGGERS



The Midnight Drift Herb Formulary

*The herbs I trust for this trigger, each with its
dose, why it helps, and the cautions that matter.*

by Joel Polley, RN

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The Midnight Drift Herb Formulary

These are the sleep-restoring herbs and nutrients for the Midnight Drift, where the goal is to rebuild deep, continuous sleep so your blood pressure can take its overnight dip again. They are educational and meant to work alongside your doctor, never instead. If you are pregnant or nursing, run every item on this list past your doctor before starting anything.

The universal rule lives at the top of every formulary in this kit: add ONE at a time, check your blood pressure daily, and tell your doctor everything you are taking.

THE ONE RULE THAT GOVERNS EVERY HERB HERE

Add ONE at a time. Check your blood pressure daily. Tell your doctor everything you are taking. If you are on BP medication these can lower your pressure further, which is the goal under monitoring; if readings run consistently below about 110/70 or you feel dizzy, call your doctor about your medication dose. Never stop or change a prescription on your own.

The Formulary

Herb / nutrient	Dose / use	Why it helps	Caution
Magnesium glycinate <i>The relaxation mineral</i>	300 to 400 mg daily, taken with dinner or before bed. Glycinate is the gold-standard form for absorption and calm. Avoid magnesium oxide, which your body barely absorbs. An evening Epsom-salt bath (a cup or two of Epsom salt, which is magnesium, dissolved in warm water, soak about twenty minutes) adds magnesium through the skin and doubles as a wind-down ritual.	Involved in over 300 functions in the body, and the mineral that poor sleep and chronic stress drain fastest. Replacing it calms the nervous system through the GABA pathway and supports the deeper stages of sleep, and many people notice their nights begin to settle within the first several evenings. This is the foundation of the whole stack. Start here.	Magnesium is cleared by the kidneys, so if you have reduced kidney function or kidney disease, talk with your doctor before supplementing and let your readings and your doctor guide the dose. If you take a calcium-channel blocker such as amlodipine, the mechanisms add up, so monitor daily. Citrate forms can loosen stools.
Tart cherry <i>The sleep restorer</i>	Taken in the evening. Follow product labeling and your doctor's guidance for the exact amount.	A natural source of melatonin that supports sleep onset and quality. Better sleep means a deeper overnight blood-pressure dip and more vascular repair, which is exactly the window the Midnight Drift steals.	Generally gentle. As with all of these, introduce it on its own and tell your doctor.

Herb / nutrient	Dose / use	Why it helps	Caution
Chamomile <i>The classic evening tea</i>	One cup of tea in the evening, about an hour before bed. Follow product labeling for brewing, and let it double as your caffeine replacement ritual.	The gentlest herb on this list and the oldest evening ritual in the book. Traditionally used to settle the body before sleep, and it fills the hand that used to hold the coffee cup, so the habit starts working for you instead of against you.	Avoid if you are allergic to ragweed or plants in the same family, since chamomile can trigger a reaction. Otherwise generally gentle. One at a time, and tell your doctor.
Passionflower <i>The sympathetic calmer</i>	Taken in the evening as a tea or extract. Follow product labeling and your doctor's guidance for the exact amount, and add it only after your foundation supports are steady.	Works on GABA receptors to calm the fight-or-flight nervous system, for the wired, racing, cannot-shut-off kind of night. Calming without heavy sedation.	Can add to the effect of sedatives, sleep medications, and blood-pressure medication. Introduce alone, monitor daily, and tell your doctor, especially if you take any calming or sleep medication.
Lemon balm (Melissa officinalis) <i>The gentle settler</i>	Taken in the evening, alone or alongside passionflower. Follow product labeling and your doctor's guidance for the exact amount.	A gentle calming herb that pairs well with passionflower for a keyed-up, cannot-settle feeling. A soft finisher for the evening stack, not a heavy lever.	Generally gentle; may add to sedative effects. As always, one at a time, monitor, and tell your doctor.

DAILY SUPPORTS (FREE, AND THE BACKBONE)

- A fixed wake time, every day of the week, weekends included: the anchor your entire body clock is set by.
- A 20-minute unhurried walk in morning sunlight to set the clock so the night knows when to arrive.
- Screens off by 9 PM, and no news or social media in the last hour before bed, to protect the melatonin window.
- A cool, fully dark room to support the deeper sleep stages where the overnight dip happens.
- Long-exhale breathing at lights-out (in 4, hold 4, out 6) to engage the vagus nerve and signal the day is over.
- Evening gratitude and prayer to hand over the worries that would otherwise run all night. "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you" (1 Peter 5:7).
- No caffeine (swap to chamomile or hibiscus tea), and no alcohol as a wind-down.
- A warm evening Epsom-salt bath, a cup or two dissolved, about twenty minutes, as a magnesium-rich wind-down ritual.

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